1% Experiment Canvas

Turn one small improvement idea into a testable experiment with a clear owner, measure and review date.

Companion to the Marginal Gains Workshop · Hypothesis-Driven Improvement · Build, Measure, Learn

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

EXPERIMENT # 3

TEAM Basket team

1 Where's the Friction? — FROM THE BOARD

Board area (tick one):

- [ ] Strategy
- [ ] Outcomes
- [ ] Product
- [ ] Teams
- [ ] Dependencies
- [ ] Engineering
- [x] Delivery
- [ ] Learning

The pain point we observed:

Stories come back from testing with missed rules: 4 of the last 9 needed rework after review.

2 Hypothesis — IF · FOR · THEN · WE'LL KNOW

If we... (the change we will make)
map the top 3 items with Example Mapping before each planning

for... (who or which part of the system)
the Basket team's refinement

then we expect... (the outcome or improvement)
fewer stories bounce back from testing for missed rules

We'll know we're right when we see... (the signal or evidence)
rework drops from 4 in 9 to 1 in 9 over two iterations

TIP: keep it small enough to start tomorrow

3 The 1% Change

What exactly will we do differently?

25 minutes of Example Mapping per item, the day before planning

Smallest version we could try first:

Map just the top item for one iteration

4 Measure — BASELINE → TARGET

BASELINE
where we are today
4 of 9 stories reworked

TARGET
what 1% better looks like
1 of 9 or fewer

HOW & WHERE MEASURED
source, frequency
the sprint board; Alex tags rework

Leading indicator (early signal): pink question cards answered before planning

Guardrail (what must not get worse): refinement stays under 1 hour a week

5 Plan & Timebox

Owner: Priya

Supporters: Alex, Tom

Start date: Sprint 15, 17 March

Mid-point check-in: Sprint 15 retro

Review date: end of Sprint 16

Timebox: [ ] 1 iteration [x] 2 iterations [ ] 1 quarter

6 Risks & Assumptions

- What must be true for this to work?
- What could go wrong, and how will we spot it?
- Who else needs to know or agree?

People will make time the day before

Priya may be in other meetings

Tell Search: they share our backlog

7 · RESULT & DECISION: COMPLETE AT THE REVIEW

What happened?

Result vs. target: 1 of 10 reworked: target met

Planning was quicker too: fewer debates about what "done" means.

Decision (tick one)

- [x] **Persevere** — It worked. Make it standard.
- [ ] **Pivot** — Promising. Adjust and re-run.
- [ ] **Stop** — No gain. Stop and share why.

What did we learn?

Most rework came from rules nobody had said out loud. Mapping surfaces them while they're cheap to change.

Share the learning with: Search & Browse, Checkout

"What's the smallest change that could prove us right or wrong?"

"If this works, who else would benefit from knowing?"

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Systems-Thinking · Continuous Improvement · Team-Led Change